xAPI Quickcards

Hands-on reference for ISEP MSc workshop — proxy, fields, validation, troubleshooting.

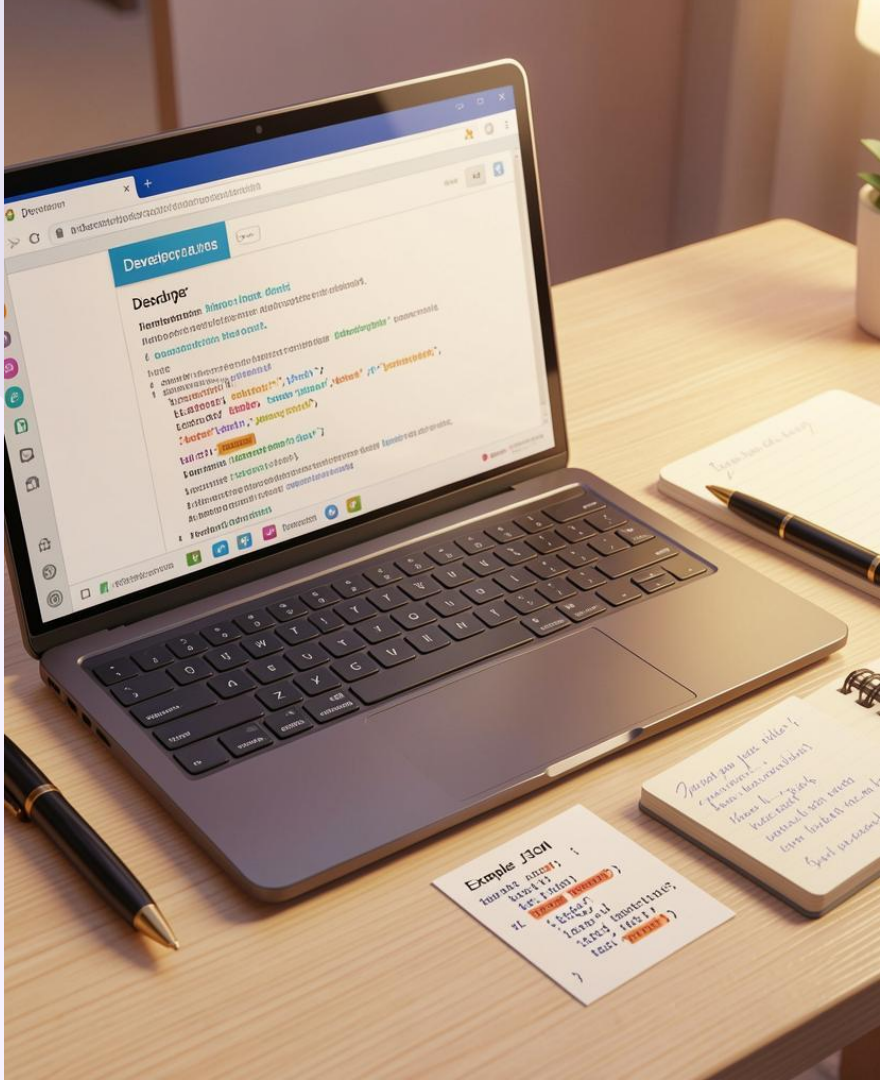
Introduction

Purpose: concise, screen-ready reference cards for sending and validating xAPI statements.

Learning aims: locate JSON keys, distinguish required fields, use the proxy endpoint, complete Twine stories, and self-diagnose common errors.

Speaker note: Point to the documentation site and proxy pattern diagram.

Mayer principle: *Multimedia principle* — visual + concise text reduces cognitive load.



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Slide Inventory

- Quick Reference: top-level fields and required status for statements.

- Troubleshooting Matrix: error → cause → fix for common LRS responses.

- Checklist Before Start: six preflight items to verify before first send.

- Statement Keys: canonical JSON keys and examples for actor, verb, object.

- Proxy Endpoint: exact URL pattern and why to avoid direct LRS calls.

Speaker note: Show site structure and locations of Twine stories.

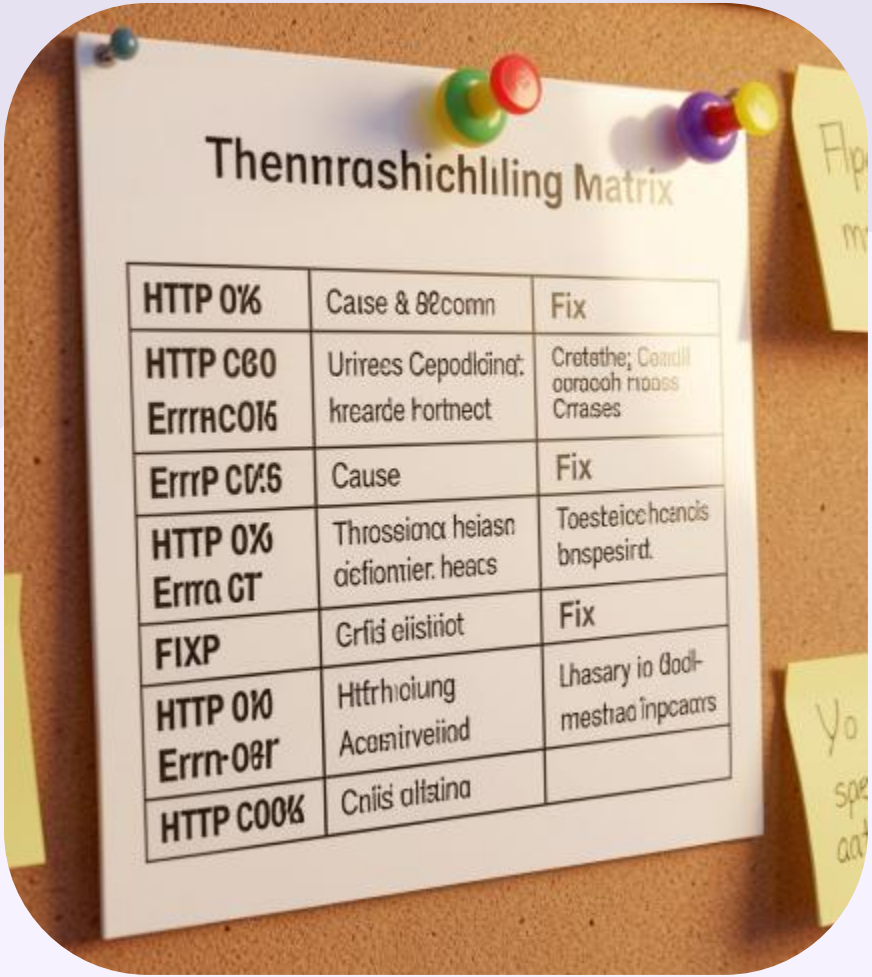
Mayer principle: *Segmenting principle* — separated cards reduce overload.

Quick Reference

Field	Required?	Type
id	N	string
actor	Y	Agent/Object
verb	Y	Verb object
object	Y	Activity/StatementRef
result	N	Object
context	N	Object
timestamp	N	datetime
stored	Y	datetime
authority	N	Agent
attachments	N	array

Speaker note: Highlight actor, verb, object as primary required fields.

Mayer principle: *Coherence principle* — only essential fields listed for clarity.



Troubleshooting Matrix

| Error | Likely Cause | Fix |

|---|---|---|

| 400 Bad Request | Malformed JSON or invalid IRI | Validate JSON and IRIs; run linter. |

| 401 Unauthorized | Proxy misconfigured or token missing | Use serverless proxy endpoint; check proxy logs. |

| 404 Not Found | Wrong proxy path or Twine story endpoint | Confirm exact proxy URL pattern on site. |

| 422 Unprocessable Entity | Schema validation failure (missing required) | Ensure actor/verb/object present and types correct. |

Speaker note: Point to LRS response body and proxy logs for diagnosis.

Mayer principle: *Signaling principle* — highlighted fixes guide attention quickly.

Checklist Before Start

- Confirm Netlify proxy URL reachable from browser.

- Open two Twine stories you will complete.

- Log into test LRS via serverless proxy only.

- Have JSON linter or editor ready.

- Verify documentation pages for IRIs and validation.

- Ensure network allows Netlify function calls.

Speaker note: Point to proxy URL and Twine story links on the documentation site.

Mayer principle: *Segmenting* — small checklist reduces cognitive load.

02 Reference Slides

- Quick Reference: top-level fields and required status.

- Troubleshooting Matrix: common errors, causes, fixes.

- Statement Keys: canonical JSON keys and examples.

- Proxy Endpoint: exact endpoint pattern and usage rule.

- Checklist: six preflight items to verify.

Speaker note: Show slide index and where each card is on second screen.

Mayer principle: *Spatial contiguity* — grouped references ease navigation.

Statement Keys

- *actor*: Agent/Object, use "mbox" or "account" for identification.

- *verb*: id (IRI) and display (language map) required.

- *object*: Activity with id IRI or StatementRef.

- *result*: score, success, completion, duration as applicable.

Speaker note: Highlight JSON snippets for actor, verb, object on screen.

Mayer principle: *Coherence* — only essential keys shown.

Required vs Optional

- Required: *actor*, *verb*, *object* — minimal valid statement.

- Stored: set by LRS on receipt (clients should not set).

- Optional often used: *result*, *context*, *attachments*.

- Use *timestamp* when client time matters; otherwise omit.

Speaker note: Point to Quick Reference table for full required list.

Mayer principle: *Signaling* — emphasis clarifies required fields.

Proxy Endpoint

- Always send statements to Netlify proxy at /api/xapi/proxy.

- Do **not** call LRS directly from browser; no secrets in client.

- Proxy handles auth and forwards to test LRS securely.

- Check proxy logs for 401/500 diagnostics.

Speaker note: Show exact proxy path and example request in browser devtools.

Mayer principle: *Redundancy* — text plus example reinforces correct flow.

Conclusions

- Use these cards as live quick-reference while completing stories.

- Confirm two Twine statements appear in LRS via proxy logs.

- Self-diagnose using Troubleshooting Matrix first, then logs.

Speaker note: Remind participants to tick checklist before first send.

Mayer principle: *Temporal contiguity* — immediate actions tied to outcomes.

Limitations:

- Sacrifices narrative depth for concise reference.

- Not suitable for complete xAPI tutorials or novices needing step-by-step.

- Best when used alongside hands-on Twine exercises and full docs.

THANKS!

Do you have any questions?

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